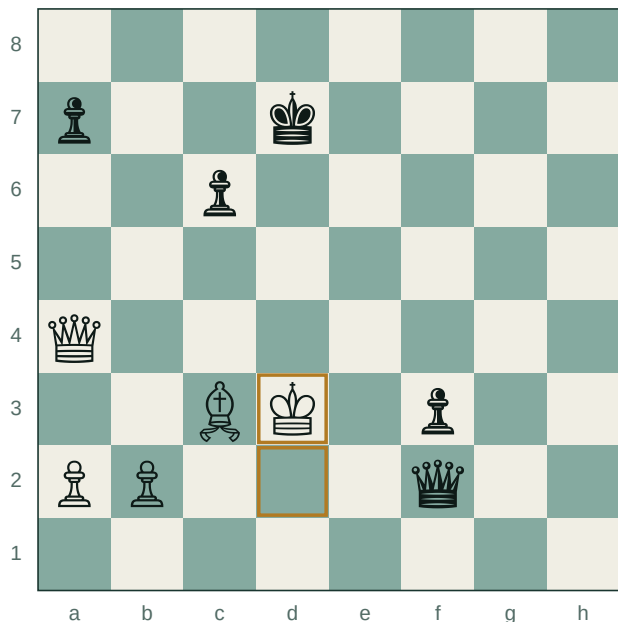


Active defensive resources: Black, move 40

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 40.Kd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

40...Qe2+ 41. Kd4 f2 42. Qxa7+ Ke6

40...Qe2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **41.Kd4**.

41...f2 The pawn moves from f3 to f2. Recorded reply: **42.Qxa7+**.

42...Ke6 The king moves from d7 to e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 14 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** -1: the balance goes from -2 to -3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on d3. Geometrically undefended: queen on a4. Check for tactical protection.